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Cyber Security Technologist - Defend and Respond

Ofqual (Office of Qualifications and Examinations Regulation)

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 31st May 2026



Reference number

462429

Salary

£34,211 - £40,990

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Higher Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

OFQUAL - Corporate Services

Type of role

Other

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Coventry, West Midlands (England), CV1 2GN

About the job

Job summary

Ofqual is the independent qualifications regulator for England. We currently regulate 200+ awarding organisations, and approx. 11,600 certified qualifications.

These include GCSEs, AS and A levels, and a broad range of vocational and technical qualifications.

For more information about the work we do please visit our website and our Careers Pages <https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/ofqual> and <https://www.civil-service-careers.gov.uk/ofqual-hub/>

About the team

The role of our Cyber Security Technologist sits in our Information Management team. It's a challenging and varied role, and you will help keep Ofqual safe – identifying vulnerabilities, threats and hazards to our systems, researching and attack techniques and recommending ways to defend. You will be working with colleagues from across the whole of government including the Government Security Group and the National Technical Authorities.

Despite the demands of the work we do, our team is friendly, supportive and we really like working together – which is important!

Job description

What the postholder will be doing?

You'll work within our Information Management team, alongside expert colleagues from our Infrastructure, Digital and Data disciplines – united by the common goals of keeping our systems online and our information safe.

You'll identify cyber vulnerabilities in our systems to ensure security is maintained.

You ll manage cyber security operations processes in accordance with organisational policies, standards and business requirements.

You ll work closely with colleagues at various levels across Ofqual, and wider government.

You ll keep up to date with industry trends and developments to enhance relevant skills and take responsibility for your own professional development

Who we re looking for?

We re looking for someone with the confidence to find creative solutions to challenging questions and good critical thinking skills.

You ll need an awareness of common cyber-attack techniques, including the role of human behaviour.

You ll need to able to build effective working relationships with people both within Ofqual and across wider government, to keep our systems safe and secure.

And now you ve heard some more about us, I look forward to receiving your application and hearing some more about you.

Person specification

Please refer to the job description attached for a full list of essential criteria to support your application.

Qualifications

Have an IT, or security qualification, or practical experience or be able to demonstrate equivalent practical experience.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Changing and Improving

Making Effective Decisions

Developing Self and Others

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Demonstrable experience analysing cyber threats, including social engineering and technical attack vectors.

Experience leading pieces of cyber security work and delivering results to deadlines.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £34,211, Ofqual (Office of Qualifications and Examinations Regulation) contributes £9,910 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.](#)

As a Civil Servant, you will benefit from a leading, modern employment offer which includes flexible working arrangements that support people at different stages in their lives, and pensions among the best available in the UK, as well as generous annual leave entitlements.

Other benefits you can enjoy include:

Organisational performance related bonus

Cycle-to-work scheme

Regular professional development

Health and wellbeing initiatives such as mini-medicals, flu vaccinations

Employee assistance programme and occupational health

Free eye tests and contribution towards lenses/spectacles for VDU users, if appropriate

Family friendly policies

Interest free rail season ticket loan

Access to exclusive discounts

Free car parking

We are committed to promoting Equality, Diversity, Inclusion and Wellbeing throughout the organisation. We are proud of the action we are taking to support this. We welcome applications from individuals from all backgrounds to support our ethos of creating a diverse culture that is reflective of both our employees and the learners we support.

Due to our continued commitment and focus in relation to Equality, Diversity and Inclusion, our inclusion and fair treatment score based on the Civil Service 2024 annual people survey ranks us joint 5th out of 104 participating departments.

Ofqual is a rewarding, dynamic place to work. We offer employees the opportunity to develop within their role and progress through the organisation via a number of Learning and Development opportunities and activities.

Ofqual has a highly engaged workforce. Our 2024 Civil Service People Survey score on engagement was **71%**, against **64%** for the whole Civil Service, and was the joint **12th** highest of the **104** participating CS departments.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Please note that Ofqual does not offer Visa sponsorship.

You will be assessed on the Behaviours shown above at interview stage.

Ofqual has adopted anonymised recruitment. This means that your name, date of birth and other personal details will not be seen by the sift panel. You will be asked to remove all personal details from your CV when you apply.

When you press the **apply now** button, you will be asked to complete personal details (not seen by the shortlisting panel), your career history and qualifications.

You will then be asked to provide a personal statement evidencing how you meet the essential criteria shown on the job description attached to this advert. Once this job has closed, the job description will no longer be available. You may wish to save a copy for your records.

Please ensure you demonstrate clearly, within your personal statement, how you meet these requirements as this will form a key part of your evidence when the panel is scoring your application, against the requirements of the role.

Should a large number of applications be received, an initial sift will be undertaken using the work history and personal statement against the lead essential criteria, which is **experience leading pieces of cyber security work and delivering results to deadlines.**

We reserve the right to offer a second interview, if required.

Please submit your application by 31 May 2026 at 23:55pm.

Application process

Stage 1 - Sift

Assessed against the essential criteria on the JD and person specification using:

Work history

Personal statement (1,250 words max)

Should a large number of applications be received, an initial sift will be undertaken using the work history and personal statement against the lead essential criterion, which is **experience leading pieces of cyber security work and delivering results to deadlines**

Selection process

Stage 2 Technical assessment

If you pass the sift process, you will be invited to book a final panel interview slot and to take part in a technical skills assessment:

This is a 10-minute **online** Q&A based assessment of specialist technical skills related to the role.

Please note, if you do not pass this assessment, we will no longer be able to progress your application to the final panel interview stage.

Interview dates 19, 22 and 29 June 2026 (subject to change).

We often have similar roles available at different grades. If a candidate is suitable for a similar role or at a lower grade than they applied for, we may extend an offer without the need to go through a further selection process, providing the role has comparable behaviours and essential criteria.

Ofqual works flexibly, with a hybrid office/home based working model. Employees will spend a minimum of two days per week working from our office in Coventry. As Coventry will be your base location expenses for travel to the office will not be paid.

Final panel interviews will be held in person. Further details will be provided at invite to interview stage.

One of our resourcing colleagues will be on hand to answer any queries you may have throughout the process.

Please be aware that expenses incurred by candidates during the recruitment process will not be reimbursed.

A reserve list may be held for up to 6 months. Ofqual may use this to fill future suitably similar vacancies for candidates who are considered appointable following interview.

Reasonable adjustments

If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you require assistance or need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should tell us what changes or help you might need further in the recruitment process.

For instance, you may need wheelchair access at an interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional. You should contact us at recruitment@ofqual.gov.uk to discuss your needs.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Ofqual Recruitment Team

Email : recruitment@ofqual.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : recruitment@ofqual.gov.uk

Further information

Our recruitment process is underpinned by the principle of appointment on the basis of fair and open competition and appointment on merit, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with these principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should first contact Ofqual by email: recruitment@ofqual.gov.uk. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive, you can then contact the Civil Service Commission, which regulates all Civil Service recruitment.

